

Dynamical systems

- How does a system evolve in time?
- By a completely deterministic rule.
 - nothing random about it, although it may appear to be random, e.g. chaotic systems

examples:

$$\dot{x} = f(x), \quad x \in \mathbb{R}^n, \quad f: \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n \text{ (vector field)}$$

$$\dot{x} = \frac{dx}{dt}$$

↑
"autonomous", f does not depend on t

$$\dot{x} = f(x, t)$$

↑ "non-autonomous"

$$f: \mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$$

↑
continuous time "flow"
discrete time "map"

↓

$$x_{n+1} = g(x_n)$$

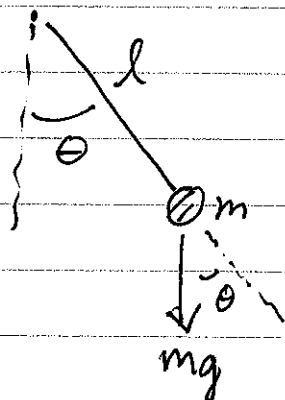
Note: in a typical differential eqns. class:

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} \dot{X} = f(x) \\ X(0) = X_0 \end{array} \right\} \begin{array}{l} \text{initial condition needed for unique} \\ \text{soln. } x(t), -T < t < T, T > 0 \end{array}$$

Here we are interested in possible behavior as a function of x_0 , and how it may change qualitatively with x_0 .

We want to visualize/characterize solns in "phase space" or "state space", e.g. in all of $\mathbb{R}^n$ if $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

Example 1: idealized pendulum



Physics side-bar

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Torque} &= \vec{r} \times \vec{F} \\ &= l m g \sin \theta (-\hat{k}) \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Torque} &= I \vec{\alpha} \\ &= (m l^2) (\ddot{\theta} \hat{k}) \end{aligned}$$

$$m l^2 \ddot{\theta} = -m l g \sin \theta$$

$$\ddot{\theta} = -\frac{g}{l} \sin \theta$$

$$= -\omega^2 \sin \theta; \omega^2 \equiv \frac{g}{l}$$

Let $\tau = \omega t = \text{dimensionless time}$

$$\frac{d}{d\tau} = \frac{dt}{d\tau} \frac{d}{dt} = \frac{1}{\omega} \frac{d}{dt}$$

$$\frac{d^2\theta}{d\tau^2} = \frac{1}{\omega^2} \frac{d^2\theta}{dt^2} = \frac{1}{\omega^2} (-\omega^2 \sin\theta) = -\sin\theta$$

$$\boxed{\frac{d^2\theta}{d\tau^2} = -\sin\theta}$$

sols. depend on
 $(\theta(0), \frac{d\theta}{d\tau}(0))$

initial angle

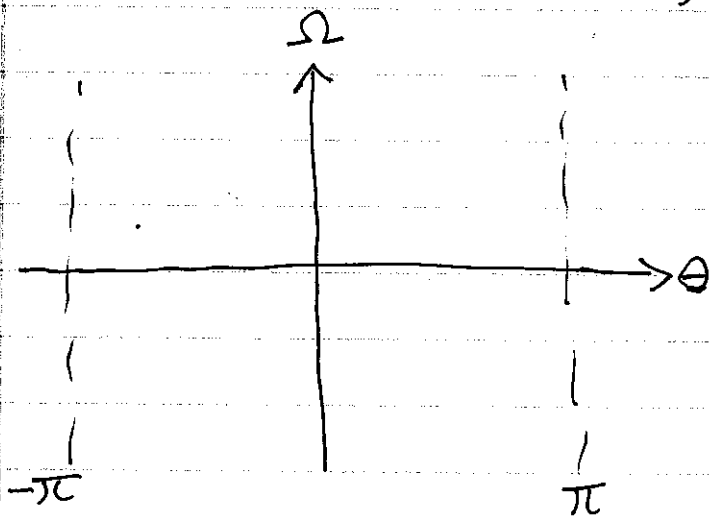
initial angular speed

2 degrees of freedom

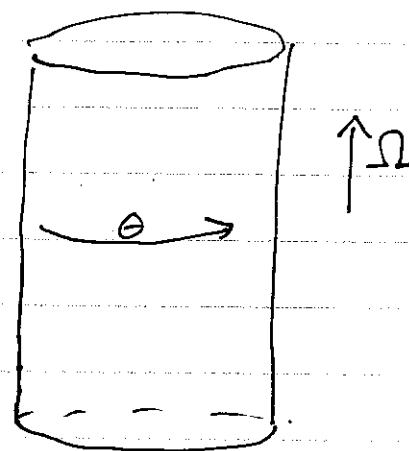
Can re-write as 2 first order eqns. using a standard trick:

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} \text{let } \frac{d\theta}{d\tau} = \Omega \\ \text{then } \frac{d\Omega}{d\tau} = -\sin\theta \end{array} \right\}$$

"phase space" variables are (θ, Ω) which completely specify the state of the system at any given time t .



phase plane = $\mathbb{R}^2$
 oops: $\theta \in [-\pi, \pi]$



phase space is a cylinder

$S^1 \times \mathbb{R}$
 angle $\rightarrow S^1$ $\leftarrow$ angular speed $\rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

Distinct types of solns.:

- 2 equilibria

$$(\theta, \Omega) = (0, 0), (\pi, 0)$$

- 3 types of oscillations



physical space.
What do they look like
in phase space?

Conservation of energy:

$$\underbrace{\frac{d\theta}{dt} \frac{d^2\theta}{dt^2}}_{\frac{1}{2} \frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{d\theta}{dt} \right)^2} = \underbrace{-\sin \theta \frac{d\theta}{dt}}_{\frac{d}{dt} (\cos \theta)}$$

$$\frac{d}{dt} \left[\underbrace{\frac{1}{2} \Omega^2}_{\text{kinetic energy}} - \underbrace{\cos \theta}_{\text{potential energy}} \right] = 0$$

kinetic
energy

potential
energy

$$\frac{1}{2} \Omega^2 - \cos \theta = E_0 = (\text{initial}) \text{ energy} = \text{constant} \text{ in time for solns } (\theta(t), \Omega(t))$$

solns in phase space are level curves of

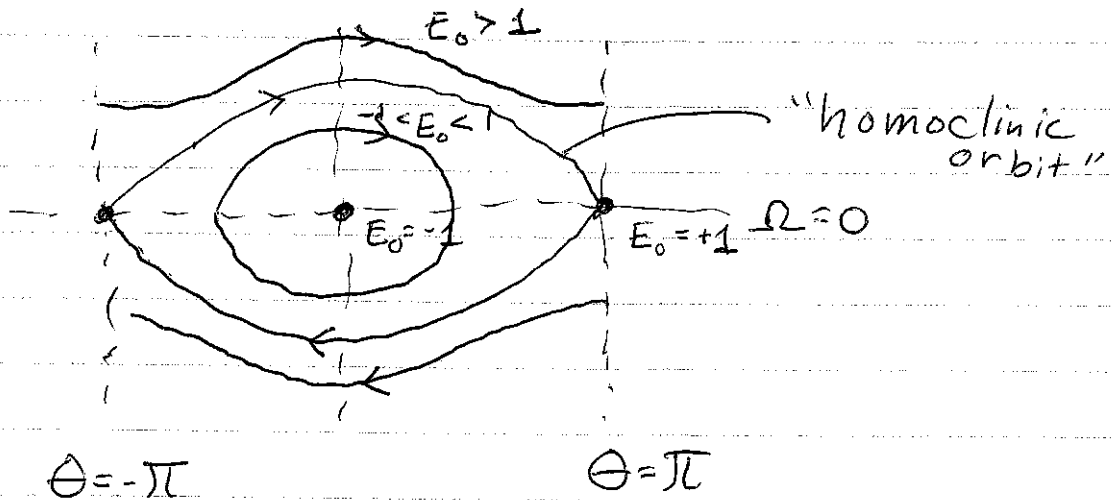
$$\underbrace{\frac{1}{2} \Omega^2}_{\geq 0} - \underbrace{\cos \theta}_{\in [-1, 1]} \geq -1$$

$$E_0 = -1 \Rightarrow \Omega = 0, \theta = 0$$

$$-1 < E_0 < 1 \Rightarrow \theta \text{ restricted}$$

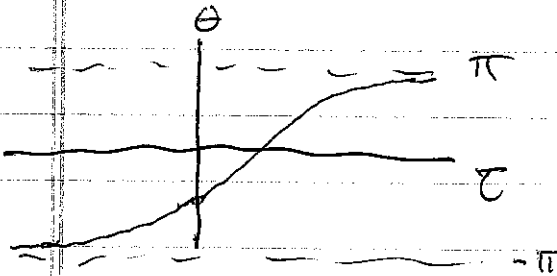
$$E_0 = +1$$

$$E_0 > +1 \Rightarrow \Omega^2 \geq 0 \begin{cases} \Omega > 0 \\ \Omega < 0 \end{cases}$$



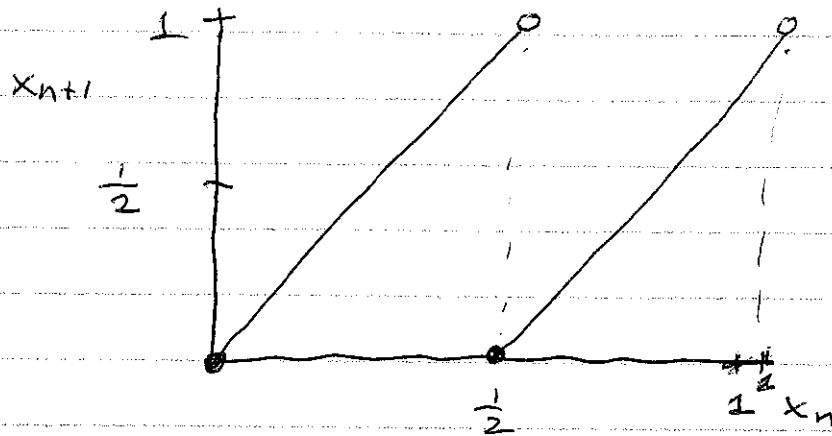
homoclinic orbit:

$$\left. \begin{aligned} \lim_{\tau \rightarrow +\infty} \Theta(\tau) &= \pi \\ \lim_{\tau \rightarrow -\infty} \Theta(\tau) &= -\pi \end{aligned} \right\} \text{same equilibrium pt. of the cylinder}$$



Example 2: a piecewise linear map

$$x_{n+1} = 2x_n \pmod{1} = T(x_n), \quad x \in [0, 1)$$



Claims about $T(x_n)$:

It has

- properties of chaotic systems
- (i) "sensitive dependence on initial conditions"
 - (ii) infinitely many periodic & aperiodic points
 - (iii) a dense orbit

(i) Sensitive dependence on initial conditions

orbit 1	$x_0, x_1, x_2, \dots$	$T(x_n) = x_{n+1}$	$x_0 \neq y_0$
orbit 2	$y_0, y_1, y_2, \dots$	$T(y_n) = y_{n+1}$	

let $\epsilon = |y_0 - x_0|$ and $\delta_n = |y_n - x_n|$
 δ_n grows to the bound of 1 for any ϵ .

(ii) periodic pts

if (minimal) period is N then

$$x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, \dots, x_N, x_1, x_2, \dots$$

ie. $x_{N+k} = x_k$

aperiodic $\Rightarrow$ doesn't repeat

(iii) a dense orbit

$$x_0, x_1, x_2, \dots$$

$\exists x_0$ s.t. orbit comes arbitrarily close to each pt. in the interval $[0, 1)$

Given any $\epsilon > 0$ and any pt. $p \in [0, 1)$ then orbit $\{x_0, x_1, \dots\}$ is dense if there is some finite N s.t. $|x_N - p| < \epsilon$.

~~Trick~~

Trick for showing all these properties:
write x_0 in binary as follows

$$\hat{x}_0 = 0, \underbrace{a_1 a_2 a_3 a_4 \dots}_{a_k \in \{0,1\}} \quad \text{in binary}$$

$a_0 = 0$

in decimal form:

$$x_0 = \sum_{j=1}^{\infty} a_j \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^j$$

$$x_1 = 2x_0 \pmod{1}$$

$$= \sum_{j=1}^{\infty} a_j \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^{j-1} \pmod{1}$$

$$= a_1 + \sum_{j=2}^{\infty} a_j \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^{j-1} \pmod{1}$$

$$= \cancel{\sum_{j=1}^{\infty} a_j \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^{j-1}} + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_{k+1} \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^k \quad \begin{matrix} j-1=k \\ j=k+1 \end{matrix}$$

$$\hat{x}_1 = 0, a_2 a_3 a_4 \dots$$

$$\hat{x}_2 = 0, a_3 a_4 a_5 \dots$$

action of map is just to shift decimal
by 1.

periodic pts are repeating & aperiodic not.

Sensitive dependence on initial conditions

$$\hat{x}_0 = 0, a_1 a_2 a_3 \dots a_N a_{N+1} a_{N+2} \dots$$

$$\hat{y}_0 = 0, a_1 a_2 a_3 \dots a_N b_1 b_2 \dots$$

N set by ϵ

$$b_j = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } a_{N+j} = 1 \\ 1 & \text{if } a_{N+j} = 0 \end{cases}$$

after N iterations of map, the orbits are as far apart as possible

iii) dense orbit by construction

Construct all sequences of length k :

$k=1$ 0, 1 2

$k=2$ 00, 01, 10, 11 4

$k=3$ 000, 001, ..., 111 8

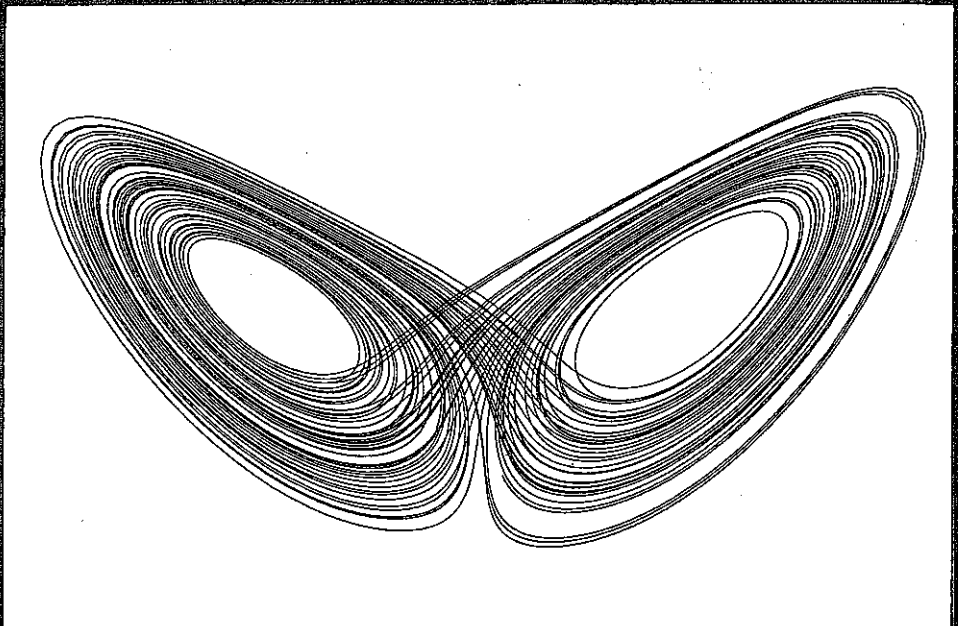
and concatenate

$$x_0 = .0100011011000001, \dots$$

CAMBRIDGE TEXTS
IN APPLIED
MATHEMATICS

Stability, instability and chaos:

an introduction to the theory of
nonlinear differential equations

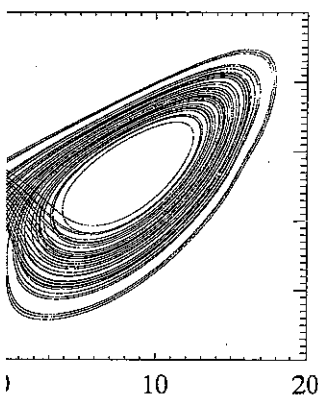


PAUL GLENDINNING

$$\frac{8}{3}z + xy. \quad (11.18)$$

ions are shown in Figure 11.1, where
ions have some geometric structure
o ∞ simple periodic orbit. We shall
of systems like the Lorenz equations

Dynamical Systems, was published
icle about a particular class of maps
igorous mathematical results about
These two papers show up some of
lking about chaos. For the applied
n is not chaotic unless it has what is
mplicated behaviour must be visible
e interested in the topological struc-
a system chaotic even if the chaotic
to know that it is there. Hence the
and co-workers is not especially in-
chaotic behaviour is not attracting,
such as the Lorenz equations are so
to prove any rigorous results about
losophy is reflected in the choice of
s. In order to prove results we shall
e it is remarkably difficult to prove
in all but the most artificial of ex-



Lorenz attractor.

amples. None the less, we shall remain aware of the dichotomy between
the study of physical examples and the rigours of theory and wherever
possible give results about attractors.

This chapter begins with some basic definitions and examples, then
goes on to develop the theory of some particularly simple maps which
have complicated (or chaotic) behaviour.

11.1 Characterizing chaos

The first step towards developing any theory is to try to establish the
most important features of the problem. As remarked above this is not
completely clear for chaotic systems and depends crucially on whether
one takes a topological point of view or chooses to ignore anything which
is not an attractor (see, for example, Exercise 1 at the end of this chap-
ter). An example may help to crystallize ideas.

Example 11.1

Consider the simple map $T : [0, 1) \rightarrow [0, 1)$ defined by

$$T(x) = 2x \pmod{1}.$$

Seen as a map from the interval to itself this map has a discontinuity at
 $x = \frac{1}{2}$ which can cause problems (see Fig. 11.2). However, this example

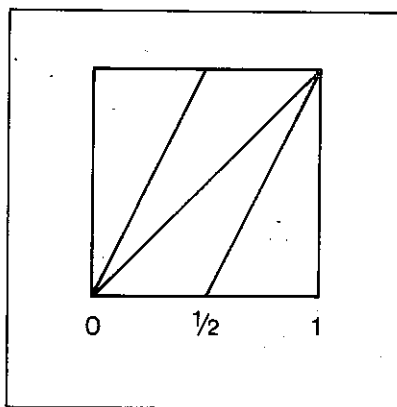


Fig. 11.2 The map $T(x) = 2x \pmod{1}$.

can be thought of as being derived from the complex map

$$z_{n+1} = z_n^2$$

by noting that if $|z_n| = 1$ then $|z_{n+1}| = 1$, so setting $z_n = e^{2\pi i x_n}$ we find that $x_{n+1} = 2x_n$ and since x is an angle it can be thought of as taking values between 0 and 1. Hence although the map is a discontinuous map of the interval it represents a continuous map of the circle. Any point $x \in [0, 1]$ can be written as a binary expansion in the form

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_i}{2^i}$$

where $a_i \in \{0, 1\}$, and so

$$2x = a_1 + \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_{i+1}}{2^i}.$$

Hence, if we identify 1 with 0,

$$T(x) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_{i+1}}{2^i}.$$

The effect of T is now clear: if x has a binary expansion $[a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots]$ then $T(x)$ has binary expansion $[a_2, a_3, \dots]$, $T^2(x)$ has binary expansion $[a_3, \dots]$ and so on. It is now possible to deduce that

- i) T has 2^n periodic points of period n (but not necessarily least period n), since there are 2^n different sequences of 0s and 1s of period n ;
- ii) if $x \neq y$ then $|T^n(x) - T^n(y)|$ grows initially like $2^n|x - y|$, since the slope of the map is 2 everywhere;
- iii) given any neighbourhood J of x , there exists a subinterval K of J and $n > 0$ such that $T^n(J) = (0, 1)$ and $T^n|_K$ is a homeomorphism, this is proved below;
- iv) periodic points are dense in $[0, 1]$, this follows from (iii): given x and a neighbourhood J , define $K = [a, b]$ and n as in (iii), then $T^n(a_+) = 0 \leq a$ and $T^n(b_-) = 1 \geq b$, now since T^n is continuous on K this implies that T^n has a fixed point in K (by the Intermediate Value Theorem) and hence T has a periodic point in K . Alternatively, simply note that the periodic points are points with periodic binary expansions. Such points are dense in $[0, 1]$;
- v) T has a dense orbit; this is by construction: let A_{mk} be a list of the possible sequences of 0s and 1s of length m , so $1 \leq k \leq 2^m$,

and let x be the point with binary

$$[A_{11}, A_{12}, A_{21}, A_{22}, A_{23}, \dots]$$

then $T^n(x)$ passes arbitrarily close

The only property that we have not uses techniques which will be useful in will dignify the statement by calling it is an ambiguity in the binary expansion $[1, 0, 0, 0, \dots] = [0, 1, 1, 1, \dots]$. This reflection on the circle on which the points (not worry about this here.

(11.1) LEMMA

Consider the map $T: [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ define the convention that $T(\frac{1}{2}) = 0$. Then for there exists an open neighbourhood, J , that $T^n(J) = (0, 1)$ and $T^n|_J$ is a homeomorphism.

Proof: Suppose that x has binary expansion a preimage of $\frac{1}{2}$ (so the binary expansion string of 0s or 1s). All points close to x agree with the binary expansion of x up to N sufficiently large we can arrange for all $[a_1, \dots, a_N, b_1, b_2, \dots]$ to lie inside an ϵ neighbourhood of x . If x is not a preimage of $\frac{1}{2}$ we can choose $M > N$ such that $T^M(x)$ is a preimage of $\frac{1}{2}$. Let y be the point with binary expansion

$$[a_1, \dots, a_M, 0, 0, 0, \dots]$$

It should be obvious that $y < x$ since

$$x - y = \sum_{i=M+1}^{\infty} \frac{a_i}{2^i}$$

and, by assumption, $a_i \neq 0$ for some $i > M$.

Similarly, let z be the point with binary expansion

$$[a_1, \dots, a_M, 1, 0, 0, \dots]$$

and note that since $a_{M+1} = 0$, $z > x$. (Y general that if

$$x = [a_1, \dots, a_k, 0, a_{k+1}, \dots] \text{ and } z = [a_1, \dots, a_k, 1, 0, a_{k+1}, \dots]$$

rived from the complex map

$$z_{n+1} = z_n^2$$

$|z_n| = 1$, so setting $z_n = e^{2\pi i x_n}$ we find $x_{n+1} = 2x_n \pmod{1}$. It can be thought of as taking although the map is a discontinuous map of the circle. Any point has a binary expansion in the form

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_i}{2^i}$$

$$a_1 + \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_{i+1}}{2^i}$$

$$= \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{a_{i+1}}{2^i}$$

x has a binary expansion $[a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots]$. $T^2(x)$ has binary expansion $[a_2, a_3, \dots]$. It is possible to deduce that

of period n (but not necessarily least 2^n different sequences of 0s and 1s of

$|y|$ grows initially like $2^n|x - y|$, since $|y|$ is ever here;

of x , there exists a subinterval K of $J = (0, 1)$ and $T^n|_K$ is a homeomorphism,

in $[0, 1]$, this follows from (iii): given K , define $K = [a, b]$ and n as in (iii), and $T^n(b_-) = 1 \geq b$, now since T^n is continuous, it follows that T^n has a fixed point in K (by Brouwer's theorem) and hence T has a periodic point. Note that the periodic points are points of density 1. Such points are dense in $[0, 1]$;

by construction: let A_{mk} be a list of 0s and 1s of length m , so $1 \leq k \leq 2^m$,

and let x be the point with binary expansion

$$[A_{11}, A_{12}, A_{21}, A_{22}, A_{23}, A_{24}, A_{31}, A_{32}, \dots]$$

then $T^n(x)$ passes arbitrarily close to every point in $(0, 1)$.

The only property that we have not proved is (iii). The proof uses techniques which will be useful in a more general context, so we will dignify the statement by calling it a lemma. Note that there is an ambiguity in the binary expansion of some points, for example $[1, 0, 0, 0, \dots] = [0, 1, 1, 1, \dots]$. This reflects the fact that T is really defined on the circle on which the points 0 and 1 are identified. We will not worry about this here.

(11.1) LEMMA

Consider the map $T : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ defined by $T(x) = 2x \pmod{1}$, with the convention that $T(\frac{1}{2}) = 0$. Then for all $x \in (0, 1)$ and all $\epsilon > 0$ there exists an open neighbourhood, J , of x of length less than ϵ such that $T^n(J) = (0, 1)$ and $T^n|_J$ is a homeomorphism.

Proof: Suppose that x has binary expansion $[a_1, a_2, \dots]$ and that x is not a preimage of $\frac{1}{2}$ (so the binary expansion does not end with an infinite string of 0s or 1s). All points close to x have binary expansions which agree with the binary expansion of x up to some stage, N . By choosing N sufficiently large we can arrange for all points with binary expansions $[a_1, \dots, a_N, b_1, b_2, \dots]$ to lie inside an ϵ neighbourhood of x . Since x is not a preimage of $\frac{1}{2}$ we can choose $M > N$ such that $a_{M+1} = 0$. Now let y be the point with binary expansion

$$[a_1, \dots, a_M, 0, 0, 0, 0, \dots].$$

It should be obvious that $y < x$ since

$$x - y = \sum_{i=M+1}^{\infty} \frac{a_i}{2^i} > 0$$

and, by assumption, $a_i \neq 0$ for some $i > M$.

Similarly, let z be the point with binary expansion

$$[a_1, \dots, a_M, 1, 0, 0, 0, \dots]$$

and note that since $a_{M+1} = 0$, $z > x$. (You should prove this: show in general that if

$$x = [a_1, \dots, a_k, 0, a_{k+1}, \dots] \text{ and } z = [a_1, \dots, a_k, 1, b_{k+1}, \dots],$$

